

If Thou but Suffer God to Guide Thee

- 1 If thou but suffer God to guide thee,
and hope in him through all thy ways,
he'll give thee strength, whate'er betide thee,
and bear thee through the evil days;
who trusts in God's unchanging love
builds on the Rock that naught can move.
- 2 What can these anxious cares avail thee,
these never ceasing moans and sighs?
What can it help, if thou bewail thee
o'er each dark moment as it flies?
Our cross and trials do but press
the heavier for our bitterness.
- 3 Be patient and await his leisure
in cheerful hope, with heart content
to take whate'er thy Father's pleasure
and his discerning love hath sent;
nor doubt our inmost wants are known
to him who chose us for his own.
- 4 All are alike before the Highest;
'tis easy for our God we know,
to raise thee up though low thou liest,
to make the rich man poor and low;
true wonders still by him are wrought
who setteth up and brings to naught.
- 5 Sing, pray, and keep his ways unswerving,
perform thy duties faithfully,
and trust his Word—though undeserving,
thou yet shalt find it true for thee;
God never yet forsook in need
the soul that trusted him indeed.

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